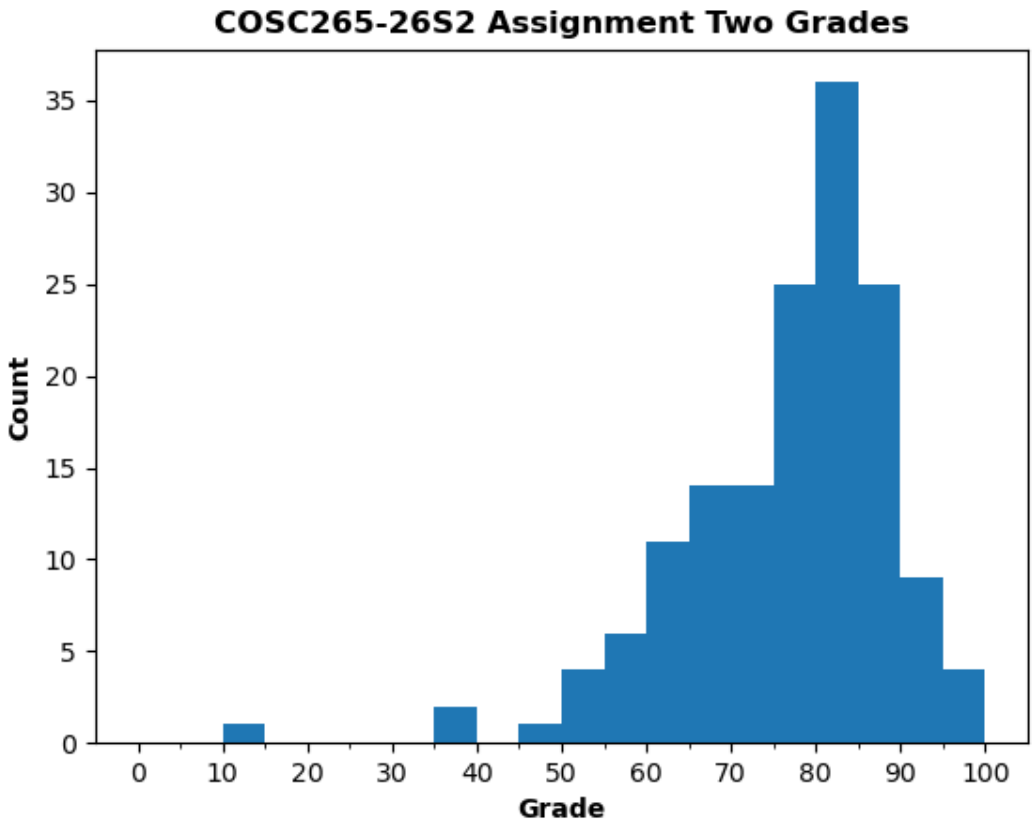
COSC265-26S2 Assignment Two Feedback

This report includes some statistics that show how grades were distributed. We then discuss the most common types errors we saw across submissions and discuss why they don't model the requirements as well as an alternative strategy. Finally, we discuss what makes a good assumption and point out some of the opportunities for making them presented within the assignment.

Statistics

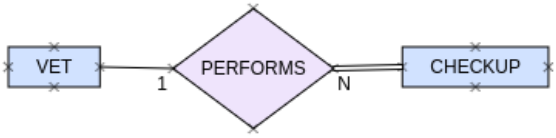


- Mean: 76.75
- Standard Deviation: 12.73

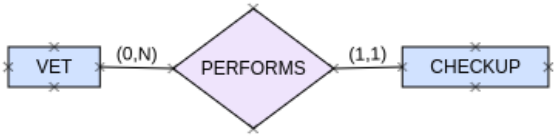
Common Errors

Here we provide feedback on errors that we saw often in work submitted by students.

Simultaneous use of participant and structural constraints. In the case of a binary relationship, you can use either structural constraints or participation constraints and cardinality ratios. The relationships below depict the same information using each convention.

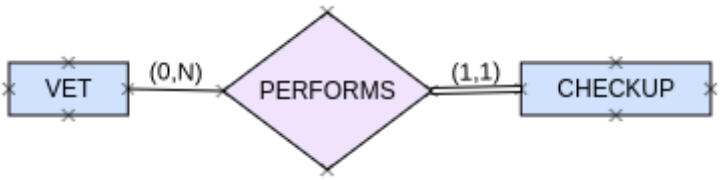


Cardinality ratios and participation constraints



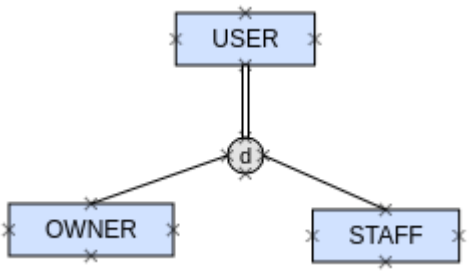
Structural constraints

Combining structural and participation constraints will at best provide redundant information and at worse contradictory information. For that reason, a response like that below is incorrect.

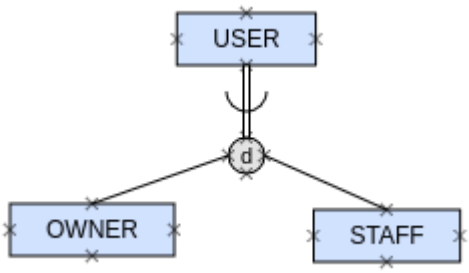


Total participation on the right edge is redundant

Incorrect use of subset symbols. We commonly encountered submissions that lacked subset symbols or placed them on the incorrect edge.

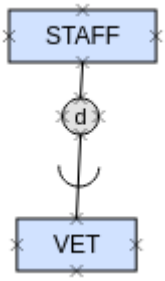


Missing subset symbols

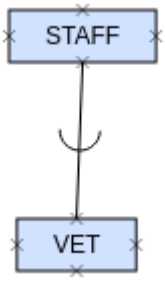


Subset symbol on incorrect edge

We occasionally saw the use of overlapping or disjoint symbol when specialising into a single sub-entity.



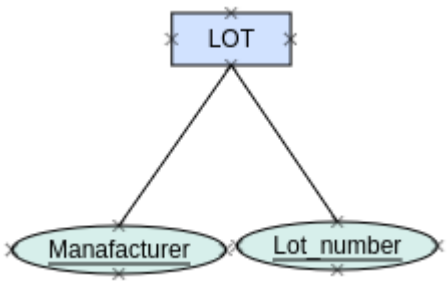
Incorrect



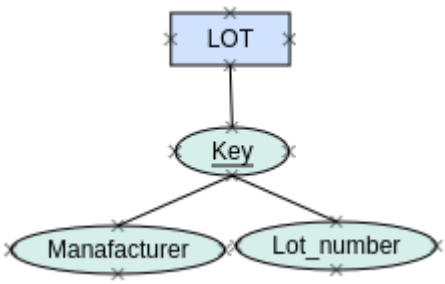
Correct

When only a single sub-entity is present a disjoint/overlapping symbol provides no information and should be omitted.

LOT identified by two primary keys. We quite commonly saw solutions that had two primary keys: manufacturer and lot number. The better way to model this was to form a single primary key using manufacturer and lot number as composite attributes.



Incorrect



Correct

It may seem that either way of modelling LOT is correct. To see that the latter is a better solution than the former consider: how many times you can place an order of MEDICINE produced by the same manufacturer?

Allowing any VET to LEAD a (surgical) TEAM. We often saw the LEADS relationship between VET and TEAM. The requirements stated that only a vet on a continuing contract could lead a team. This restriction can be modelled by forming a sub-entity that inherits from both CONTINUING and VET entities; and then connecting LEADS to the sub-entity.

Assumptions

The assumptions within your report should document choices that you made when the requirements provided did not take a clear position as to what should be modelled.

Below are *a few* examples where the requirements were silent, and thus an assumption was justified.

- The type of specialisation to be used between USER and STAFF and OWNER: could be overlapping or disjoint.
- If a PET must be in the HAS relationship (with SERVICE): could be total or partial.
- How many times a CONTINUING_VET can be in the LEADS relationship: could be 1 or N.

You could adopt either position (and almost all submissions had adopted one or the other); we were looking for you to pass comment on the fact you had made a choice and outline why you adopted the position you had.